Lumen's real problem is *belonging.*

We give every Lumenite a shared past, a shared place and a shared weekly rhythm

WHAT WE SEE

People finish work and go home alone. Gatherings are empty. Life is

"functional but empty"

ONE LUMEN YEAR



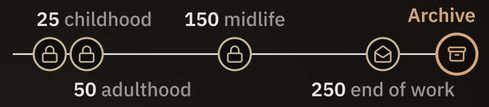
The 13th moon is Lumen's high season: it opens with the Carrying (day 1) and closes with the league final (day 32).

WHY **No shared past** (no history)
SO the family, across time

TRADITION

The Four Letters

A shared past



- Every Lumenite writes **four letters in a life**, each at home with the household gathered, on the day they reach that age.
- Letters 1–3 **stay sealed**. At 250 you open them, read your life back, and write the fourth.
- The 250 letter is **for your children and theirs**, kept with your photo as the family's record of who you were.
- After death, the letters go to the **Lumen Archive**, open to any future Lumenite if the writer allowed it while alive.
- In Year 1, the **~8,300 Lumenites** already past 250 write first, so history starts on day one.

Belonging: every family gains a written past, and the Archive grows into the whole planet's shared history.

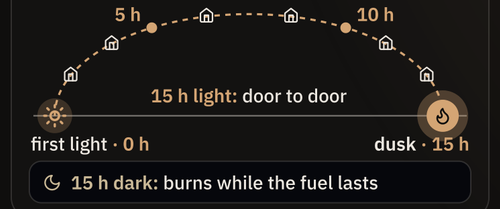
Only on Lumen: a 300-year life lets you open your own letters 225 years after the first.

WHY **No shared place** (nothing smaller than a city of 50,000 to belong to)
SO the district, once a year

FESTIVAL

The Carrying

A shared place · Day 1 of the 13th moon



- Each of the 100 districts carries **one flame to every home** it has: ~125 homes, door to door from first light.
- Every household adds what fuel it can. Fuel is **precious gas**, so each home gives part of its wealth.
- **At dusk** the flame is set in the district square for all 500 to see. It burns through the night for as long as the district's gift lasts.

Belonging: the flame exists only because every door gave. Fire stands for hope and togetherness.

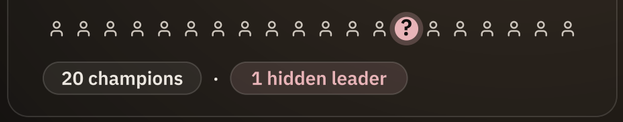
Only on Lumen: the fuel is the currency itself, and a 15-hour night gives the flame its stage.

WHY **No shared rhythm** (nothing to look forward to, so work fills the time)
SO the whole planet, every week

ENTERTAINMENT

The Hidden Head League

A shared rhythm · Every week



- Each season, every district draws **20 champions by lot**; one is secretly the leader.
- Each week the districts **play in pairs (50 matches)**.
- Each round, the **hidden leader quietly steers** their side through a task; the other side watches who the players follow and names one suspect. A wrong name clears that suspect and costs the next guess; the first side to name the other's leader wins.
- Moons 1–12 are the league; in the 13th moon the **top 16 play a knockout**, with the final on the last night of the year.
- Spectators bet in gas on the leader: **the earlier the bet, the bigger the payout** (up to 20× in round 1, falling as suspects are cleared). Stakes are capped; the house cut pays the champion district's prize.

Belonging: a weekly reason to leave work and stand with your district. Every adult plays about 12 seasons in a life.

Only on Lumen: the planet's real leader is secret, so its favourite game is finding one.

KEY ASSUMPTIONS 1 Ages are in Lumen years (50 = Earth 18, so 25 ≈ Earth 9). 2 The moon cycle is 32 days, giving 13 moons a year (13 × 32 = 416 days). A week is 8 days, giving 52 weeks. 3 There are 100 districts of 500 people, with ~4 per home, so ~125 homes each. 4 Precious gases also burn as fuel, so fuel is money. 5 Ages are spread evenly, about 167 people per birth-year, so ~8,300 people are already past 250. 6 Open-air squares hold a whole district. The 1,000-seat Hall hosts the playoffs. 7 Betting is legal (the economy is capitalist), with a cap per person.